EXECUTIVE AI BRIEFING / THE LEADERSHIP DECISION

TOO MANY AI OPPORTUNITIES. TOO LITTLE CAPACITY.

What executives must change when ambitions outgrow the organization's ability to deliver.

THE PRESSURE

AI demand keeps expanding

- Business requests
- Easy-to-start pilots
- Executive expectations

The same people carry the load

Domain experts, data teams, controls and operational owners are needed for each project, usually without other responsibilities disappearing.

01 THREE CAPACITIES TO FUND

Decision capacity

Choose priorities, move resources, and stop work that no longer earns its place.

Proof: an executive decision record.

Delivery capacity

Release real specialist and business time; name what current work will give way.

Proof: a credible resource and dependency plan.

Operating capacity

Change workflows, handle exceptions and sustain the service beyond the pilot.

Proof: a named service owner and operating plan.

02 FIVE COMMITMENTS BEFORE DELIVERY

A bounded experiment can proceed earlier; a delivery commitment must pass this test.

01	OUTCOME	What business result and evidence would justify continuing?
02	OWNER	Who owns the result and the service after the project team leaves?
03	RELEASED TIME	Which roles are needed, and what existing work will give way?
04	DEPENDENCIES	What shared data, risk or platform constraints must be resolved?
05	EVIDENCE & EXIT	What is the next gate, and what would make us stop or change course?

03 THE PORTFOLIO DECISION

PROCEED

Value, ownership and available capacity are credible.

DEFER

A prerequisite or critical resource is missing.

REDESIGN

Narrow scope or combine shared work.

STOP

Evidence does not warrant further commitment.

NEXT EXECUTIVE MOVE

Review the active AI portfolio and its scarce people together. For each new priority, decide what the organization will do less of to make room.

Evidence: MIT Sloan (2026) · MIT CISR (2026) · BCG (2026) · McKinsey (2026) | Author-developed management test



Jair Ribeiro
AI LEADER
Enterprise AI Adoption • Governance • Business Transformation

CAPACITY BEFORE COMMITMENT